

Global Citizenship & Equity

Mental Health Awareness and Equality in the Philippines

Group 6 | PSHS 104

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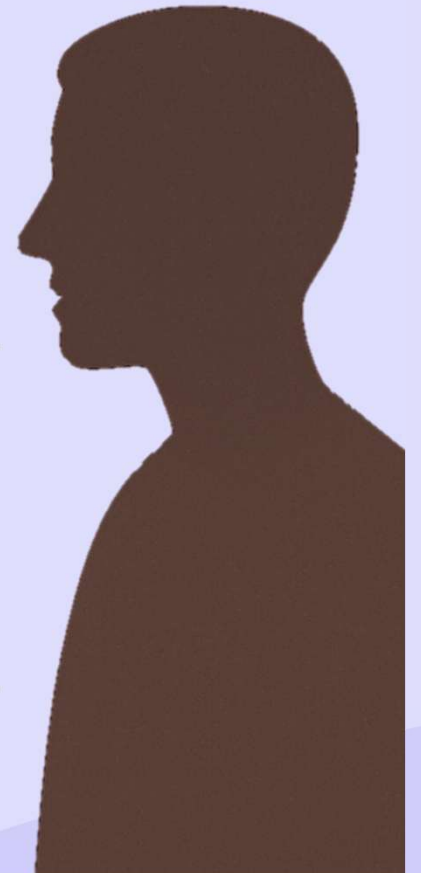
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Overview

Purpose To explore mental health laws, stigma, and equity issue in the Philippines

Focus Compare with Canada, identify vulnerable groups, and connect to PSW roles



Laws Protecting People: The Philippines

RA 11036 (2018) : Ensures access to
mental health service and
protection from discrimination
(**The LAWPHiL Project, 2018**)

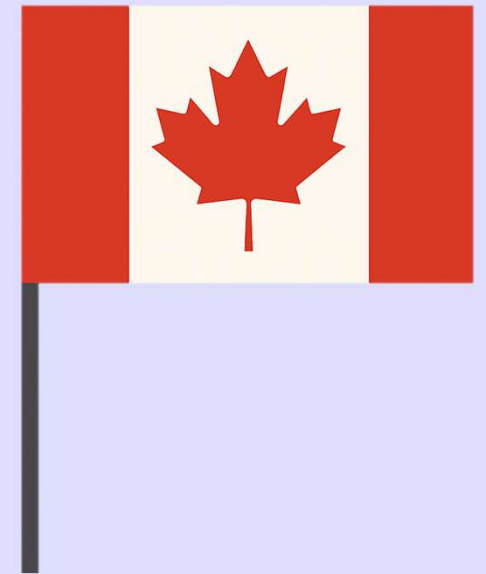
RA 7277 : Include psychosocial
disabilities and equal rights to
education and work
(**The LAWPHiL Project, 1992**)

Labor Code : Prohibits
discrimination or unfair dismissal
due to mental health conditions

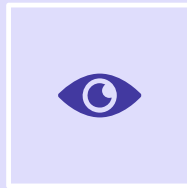


Laws Protecting People: Canada

- Ontario Human Rights Code:
Prohibits discrimination based on disability
(Ontario Human Rights Commission, 2016)
- AODA (2005): Requires accessible workplaces and accommodations **(Government of Ontario, 2025)**
- Canadian Human Rights Act: Protects mental health equality nationwide



Stigma and Beliefs (Philippines)



Signs

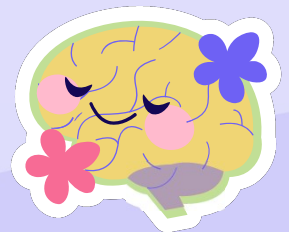
Traditional beliefs link mental illness with moral failure

NCMH promotes public education and understanding
(National Center for Mental Health, 2025)



Relief

#StopTheStigma and
#MentalHealthPH reduce
prejudice
(PowerVision EAP, Inc. 2022)

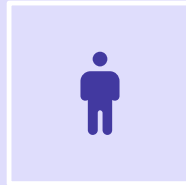


Stigma and Beliefs (Canada)



Essential

87% of Canadians believe
mental health equals
physical health
**(Canada Mental Health
Association, 2023)**



Individual

Stigma remains for
schizophrenia and
addiction



Unique

Self-stigma prevents treatment
seeking
(Government of Canada, 2024)



Discrimination & Equal Rights



Work

Fear of disclosure due to stigma
(HealSpace Psychological Clinic, 2025)



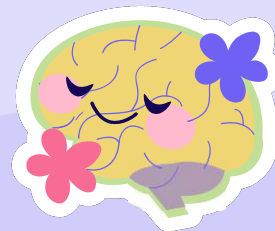
Education

Anti-stigma laws exist but need stronger enforcement
(HealSpace Psychological Clinic, 2025)



Housing

Lack of targeted programs,
discrimination by landlords
(PowerVision EAP, Inc. 2022)



Key Takeaway – Legal comparison

- Both countries recognize mental health as a human right
- Canada has stronger implementation
- The Philippines continues to develop awareness and infrastructure



Equity Efforts in the Philippines

- **DOH & NGOs** improve community mental health programs.
- **Mind You Mental Health Systems** and **National Alliance on Mental Illness** provide mental health training (**Lalogo, 2025**).
- Schools applying 2021 Mental Health Framework (**Lalogo, 2025**).



Helpful Phrases for PSWs

“Magandang umaga! Kumusta ka?” → ‘Good morning! How are you?’

“Sabihin mo lang kung may kailangan ka.” → ‘Just tell me if you need anything?’

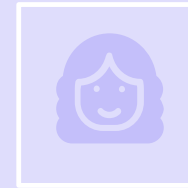


Who Is Most Affected – Youth & Women



Youth

Depression, anxiety, suicide
due to stress and poor access
(The Philippine Star, 2024),



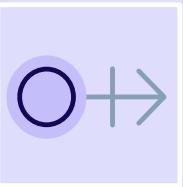
Women

Linked to domestic violence,
poverty discrimination
(Samaniego, 2022)

RA 11036 protects rights but implementation remains limited
(World Health Organization, 2025).



Who Is Most Affected LGBTQ+ & Indigenous People



LGBTQ +

Face poverty and displacement



**Indigenous
People**

High depression and anxiety rates from discrimination



Examples

Louis Marasigan about trans discrimination
(Manipon, 2022)

Lumad protests **(Beltran, 2024)**

Class Engagement

- **Question 1:** How does stigma in mental health affected your well-being in Canada? Did you adjust your beliefs?

Class Engagement

- **Question 2:** What do you think of Netherlands' Openly Gay Prime Minister who is Engaged to an Olympian?

Class Engagement

- **Question 3:** Will there be chance that Canada and the Philippines might elect a LGBTQ+ member in the future?

PSW Role – Promoting Equity

- Provide compassionate care
- Use therapeutic communication
 - Respect cultural beliefs
- Advocate fairness and self-care



Comparative Reflection (Canada vs Philippines)

- **Philippines:** RA 11036 (2018)
- **Canada:** AODA (2005)
- **Accessibility:** Enforced vs Developing
- **Stigma:** High vs Moderate
- **Focus:** More Inclusion vs Advocacy

Conclusion

- Mental health equity needs laws, education, and compassion.
- PSWs are vital in reducing stigma promoting access.
- Together, we build inclusive care environments.

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*Thank you so much
for listening!*